

FRANCE

Visa Application Guide for Pakistani Applicants

Student / Long-Stay Visa (Études en France) & Short-Stay (Schengen) Visa

This guide is based on the official France-Visas portal, Campus France Pakistan, and the AEG Travel Services one-pager (France's outsourced visa partner in Pakistan). It covers the **Student (Long-Stay) Visa** — including the mandatory Études en France (EEF) procedure for Pakistani applicants — and the **Short-Stay (Schengen) Visa** used for tourism, family visits and short study/training.

■ Major change from 1 August 2026

The minimum financial resources required for a long-stay French student visa/residence permit has risen from €615/month to **€877.50 per month** (about €10,530/year), replacing a threshold that had been unchanged since 2002. This applies to applications submitted from 1 August 2026 onward — see Section 4.4 for details.

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1. Know Your Visa Type

Visa Type	Purpose	Duration
Short-Stay (Schengen) Visa	Tourism, business, family visits, short training/conferences, study ≤90 days	Up to 90 days in any 180-day period, across the Schengen Area
Long-Stay Visa — VLS-TS	Study, work, or long-stay for personal/family reasons exceeding 90 days; acts as a residence permit once validated	3 months to 1 year (renewable via a prefecture for longer stays)
Long-Stay Visa — “residence card to be applied for”	Same purposes, but requires an in-person prefecture visit within 2 months of arrival to get a residence permit	As above
Student examination visa (étudiant-concours)	Sitting an entrance exam/interview for a French higher-education institution	Max. 90 days; can be regularised locally if you pass

2. Short-Stay (Schengen) Visa

The short-stay visa is the most commonly issued visa for tourist travel, business trips or family visits, and also covers short training programmes, internships, conferences and corporate meetings, or paid activities of any kind, provided the total stay does not exceed 90 days. It is also required for certain forms of airport transit outside the international zone.

2.1 The “Uniform Schengen” short-stay visa

- Valid for transit through, or stay in, part or all of the Schengen Area
- Cannot exceed 90 days in any 180 consecutive days
- The visa sticker states which Schengen territories the holder may enter

2.2 Which country's mission should you apply to?

- France is your only destination (you may then apply for a multiple-entry visa)
- You are visiting several Schengen states but France is your main destination by duration or purpose
- You are visiting several Schengen states with no clear “main” destination, and France is your first point of entry

2.3 Multiple-entry “circulation visa”

Frequent travellers to France may, under certain conditions, be eligible for a multiple-entry visa valid from 6 months up to 5 years, subject to proof of a genuine need/intention to travel frequently and a track record of reliability from previously granted visas. The French administration determines both eligibility and the validity period on a case-by-case basis.

3. Long-Stay Visa — General Categories

Any stay in France exceeding 90 days requires a long-stay visa in advance — your nationality does not exempt you from this requirement. A long-stay visa is always valid for between 3 months and 1 year; to stay longer, you must apply for a residence permit at a French prefecture before it expires.

During its validity, a long-stay visa functions like a Schengen visa for travel elsewhere in the Schengen Area, allowing up to 90 days of travel outside France in any 180-day period.

3.1 Two main long-stay categories

- **VLS-TS** (long-stay visa valid as a residence permit) — for stays of 1 year or less; exempts you from separately applying for a residence permit, but you must **validate** the VLS-TS within 3 months of arrival via the ANEF (Administration Numérique des Étrangers en France) portal.
- **Long-stay visa with “residence card to be applied for”** — you must present yourself at the prefecture within 2 months of arrival to obtain a residence permit (in some cases, e.g. under the “Passeport-Talent” scheme, a multi-annual permit may be issued).

A temporary long-stay visa (VLS-T) also exists, mainly for those certain not to extend their stay beyond the visa's validity.

4. Student / Long-Stay Visa — Full Detail

4.1 Eligibility

- You must be **18 years or older**
- You must have already chosen your training course or programme of study (see Campus France for course/diploma details)
- You must be accepted by a recognised higher-education establishment
- Depending on age and whether you are enrolling in the first year of a programme, you may also need to follow the **Parcoursup** procedure and respect its schedule

4.2 Pakistan is an EEF-procedure country

All Pakistan-based applicants use Études en France

Pakistan appears on France's official list of countries/territories covered by the **Études en France (EEF)** online enrolment scheme. This means virtually all Pakistani residents applying to study in France — at any level, from Bachelor's to most Master's and PhD programmes — must go through the EEF platform before applying for their visa. (The main exception is PhD candidates in Pakistan applying under a Doctoral Fellowship.) See Section 5 for the full procedure.

4.3 Which visa will you receive?

- Training/course of **3 months or less**: you receive a short-stay visa
- Training/course **longer than 3 months**: you receive a long-stay visa (VLS-TS), which then requires the arrival formalities described in Section 10

4.4 Financial resources requirement (updated 1 August 2026)

Applies to	Previous threshold	New threshold (from 1 Aug 2026)
Long-stay student visa / student residence permit (first application & renewal)	€615 / month (unchanged since 2002)	€877.50 / month (≈€10,530/year) — set at 47% of the gross SMIC

This change comes from Decree No. 2026-526 (22 June 2026) and applies to any application **submitted on or after 1 August 2026** — what matters is your submission date, not when your current visa (if renewing) expires. The threshold is now indexed and may be revised at least once a year by ministerial order, so always check the current figure on France-Visas or Campus France before finalising your budget documents.

You can demonstrate the required funds through:

- Personal savings / recent bank statements (in your name or a sponsor's)
- A blocked account or equivalent guaranteed funds
- A scholarship award letter
- An official letter from a sponsor or family member covering the full duration of your stay

4.5 Visa fees for students

Applicant category	Indicative fee
Countries/territories with the EEF procedure (incl. Pakistan)	€50*
Other countries (non-EEF)	€99*

*Indicative; special cases may attract different rates.

4.6 Supporting documents

The exact list is generated by the France-Visas **visa wizard** for your specific situation, but at minimum you must include your **certificate of enrolment** from the higher-education institution that has accepted you, alongside the standard identity, financial and accommodation documents.

4.7 Special student situations

- **Entrance-exam applicants** (étudiant-concours): issued a short-stay visa valid up to 90 days, which can be regularised at the prefecture if you pass the exam — without needing to return home to apply for a long-stay visa. Note: this route is not available to Algerian nationals under the Franco-Algerian Agreement.
- **Medical students** (DFMS/DFMSA specialisation): issued a long-stay visa equivalent to a residence permit for studies, selected via the French Embassy's cultural services during the first quarter of the year.
- **Student mobility** (EU programme or inter-institution agreement): issued a visa marked “Étudiant – mobilité” — either a VLS-TS (mobility ≤ 12 months) or a long-stay visa with prefecture registration (mobility > 12 months).

4.8 Life as a student in France

- **Tuition:** fees vary by institution, from a few hundred euros up to over €10,000/year at some private institutions, plus possible additional service fees
- **Accommodation:** contact your host institution's international relations office; provide a temporary address for your first 3 months (or your permanent address if already arranged) on your visa application
- **Working while studying:** non-Algerian foreign students may work up to 964 hours (60% of full-time hours in France); Algerian nationals are limited to 50%. Part-time work should be treated as a secondary income source, not your main means of support

- **Health cover:** registration for French social security is free and mandatory for non-European students under 28 (via the dedicated student health-insurance website); EEA students with a valid European Health Insurance Card, or with private insurance covering all medical risks, are exempt. Social Security typically reimburses around 60% of costs, with student insurance schemes covering the remainder

5. The Études en France (EEF) Procedure for Pakistan

Études en France (EEF) is the mandatory online platform for essentially all Pakistani residents applying to study in France, run locally by **Campus France Pakistan** (a public agency under the French Ministry of Foreign Affairs). It manages your enrolment process end-to-end, up to the point of your visa application.

5.1 Who must use EEF?

- **All Pakistan residents** applying to study in France, regardless of programme level, must apply via EEF with Campus France Pakistan — the only general exception is PhD applicants in Pakistan applying under a Doctoral Fellowship
- If you are currently living/studying in a country other than Pakistan, you must apply through the EeF platform of your country of **residence**, not Pakistan

5.2 Step-by-step EEF process

Step 1. Create your account on the EeF platform (the registered email becomes your only channel of communication for the whole application — do not share it with third parties).

Step 2. Complete your personal information and upload all required supporting documents.

Step 3. Select up to **7 Master's programmes** or **3 Bachelor's programmes** from the EeF programme list, and submit your file with payment by the annual deadline (deadlines are set each academic year — e.g. file submission by 30 November and payment completed by 12 December in a recent cycle).

Step 4. After your file is validated, Campus France Pakistan invites you to an **academic interview**, booked only through the EeF portal, held at the nearest Alliance Française (Islamabad, Lahore or Karachi). Bring all original documents plus your EeF fee payment receipt — these are checked against your uploaded file, and your payment is validated only after this interview.

Step 5. French higher-education institutions review your application and indicate on EeF whether you are admitted (in a recent cycle, results were released by 30 April, with roughly one month to confirm your final choice of programme).

Step 6. Once your final academic programme is confirmed and payment is validated, you receive your **Études en France Certificate** — required before you can book your visa appointment.

■ No walk-ins, and strict deadlines

Campus France Pakistan's office is not open without an appointment. You cannot change your choice of programmes after the file-submission deadline. Missing any EEF deadline (application, payment, or final programme choice) results in an abandoned file, and you would need to reapply in a later cycle.

5.3 EEF fee payment

The EEF fee is paid to **Alliance Française Karachi** by bank transfer or deposit, using the reference format **EEF/SURNAME OF APPLICANT/EEF NUMBER OF APPLICANT**. After paying, you must immediately declare the payment in your EeF profile, and email a scanned copy of the deposit slip to the Embassy's cooperation office — all within one week of receiving the payment request.

6. The AEG Appointment Process in Pakistan

All visa appointments on ordinary passports — for both short-stay and long-stay/student visas — are booked through **AEG Travel Services (Pvt) Ltd**, France's official outsourced visa partner, at one of its offices across Pakistan (Karachi, Lahore, Islamabad, Multan, Sialkot).

■ AEG is not affiliated with travel agents

AEG explicitly states it does not authorise any travel agent or third party to book appointments on an applicant's behalf. Self-appearance is mandatory (or a blood relative may book on your behalf). Any individual or agency claiming they can guarantee you an appointment or a particular outcome is making a false claim — AEG will not be responsible for issues arising from engaging such parties.

6.1 Steps to book a student visa appointment

Step 1. Complete your France-Visas application form fully online.

Step 2. Deposit **PKR 30,000** by bank transfer to Alliance Française Karachi's Askari Bank account (reference must include your full name and EEF application number, e.g. PKXX-XXXXXX) — this is a prerequisite before AEG will allow you to book an appointment.

Step 3. Obtain your **Études en France Certificate (attestation)** and your **Campus France payment receipt** — appointments will not be issued without both documents.

Step 4. Book your appointment with AEG. Appointments are prioritised by the course start date shown on your Études en France certificate; if all slots are filled, you must email AEG directly to request one.

Step 5. Attend your appointment at the French Embassy (Diplomatic Enclave, Islamabad) with your CV, motivation letter, admission/invitation confirmation letter, scholarship confirmation (if applicable), all previous degrees and transcripts, and any other supporting education documents plus the full France-Visas checklist.

6.2 On interview day

- Islamabad applicants report to the Diplomatic Shuttle Service (3rd Avenue, near Quaid-e-Azam University Road, G-5, Islamabad) to be shuttled to the Embassy — arrive at least 30 minutes before your scheduled time
- Biometric data (photograph + fingerprints of both hands) is collected; children under 12 are exempt from fingerprinting
- Interview/appointment dates are tentative and can be changed by the Embassy without notice
- Dates cannot be arranged by phone or email — only via the official AEG booking process

7. Fees Summary

Fee item	Amount	Notes
Student visa fee (EEF-procedure countries, incl. Pakistan)	€50*	Payable per the France-Visas fee schedule
Student visa fee (non-EEF countries)	€99*	For comparison; does not apply to most Pakistani applicants
EEF platform fee	Deposited to Alliance Française Karachi	Amount specified individually by Campus France Pakistan per applicant/programme
AEG appointment deposit (student applicants)	PKR 30,000	Prerequisite before AEG will issue an appointment
AEG service charge — Islamabad office	€8.12/file	Paid in PKR at the prevailing exchange rate, in cash
AEG service charge — Punjab	€11.10/file	Paid in PKR, in cash
AEG service charge — Sindh	€10.00/file	Paid in PKR, in cash
AEG service charge — Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	€11.50/file	Paid in PKR, in cash
AEG service charge — Balochistan	€11.50/file	Paid in PKR, in cash
Schengen short-stay visa fee	Set by France-Visas fee schedule	Check the current schedule on France-Visas before applying

*Indicative; check the France-Visas visa wizard for the exact, current fee applicable to your case.

8. Processing Times

- **EEF review (initial file check):** around 1 week for an initial status update after online submission
- **Visa processing (from full file submission):** generally between 2 weeks and 2 months, depending on the complexity of the case and completeness of documents
- **Étudiant-concours visa:** can only be finalised once entrance-exam results are known, typically within about 90 days

Plan with margin

Given the sequential nature of EEF file review, academic interview, programme confirmation, EEF certificate issuance, AEG deposit, and visa appointment booking, start the process as early as possible — ideally as soon as the EeF campaign opens for your intended intake.

9. Supporting-Document Framework

France-Visas uses an interactive **visa wizard** to generate the precise document list for your individual case (nationality, visa type, purpose, personal circumstances). The framework below shows the general families of documents you should expect to prepare.

Document family	Typical items	Applies to
Identity	Passport (valid well beyond intended stay), CNIC, photographs	All applicants
Application	France-Visas online form finalised and printed	All applicants
Purpose of travel	Certificate of enrolment (students); invitation letter/hosting certificate (family visits); itinerary/hotel bookings (tourism)	Category-specific
Financial means	Bank statements, blocked account, scholarship letter, or sponsor's letter (students: ≥€877.50/month from 1 Aug 2026)	All applicants, thresholds vary by category
Insurance	Travel/health insurance meeting Schengen minimums for short stays	Short-stay applicants primarily
Accommodation	Temporary or permanent address in France for the visa period	All applicants
Academic	Études en France Certificate, admission letter, past degrees/transcripts	Student applicants

■ Digitisation of documents

France-Visas allows applicants — initially long-stay student visa applicants in countries where the process is outsourced — to upload digital copies of all supporting documents online before their appointment. This speeds up your in-person visit, but you must ensure the documents are legible and correctly filed under the right sections; erroneous or missing digitisation may result in additional service charges to correct on the spot.

10. Post-Arrival Requirements

- **Validate your VLS-TS** within 3 months of arrival in France via the ANEF (Administration Numérique des Étrangers en France) online portal — this step is mandatory and there is a validation fee to pay online
- If your visa carries the “residence card to be applied for” mention, present yourself at your local prefecture within **2 months** of arrival to obtain your residence permit
- Register for French social security (mandatory and free for non-EEA students under 28) through the dedicated student health-insurance registration website
- Keep proof of your accommodation address for the first 3 months of your stay, as this may be requested by the prefecture or ANEF

11. Application Checklist

For student applicants:

- Create your EeF account and submit your programme choices and documents by the campaign deadline
- Pay the EEF fee to Alliance Française Karachi and declare payment on the EeF portal within 1 week
- Attend your academic interview at an Alliance Française with all original documents

- Confirm your final programme choice once admitted, and obtain your Études en France Certificate
- Complete the France-Visas application form online
- Deposit PKR 30,000 with Alliance Française Karachi to unlock AEG appointment booking
- Book your AEG appointment, referencing your EEF number and certificate
- Attend your interview at the Embassy in Islamabad with the full supporting-document set
- After arrival in France: validate your VLS-TS via ANEF within 3 months, and register for social security if eligible

For short-stay (tourist/family/short study) applicants:

- Use the France-Visas visa wizard to generate your personalised document list
- Complete the France-Visas online application form
- Gather identity, financial, insurance, accommodation and purpose-of-travel documents
- Book your appointment through AEG Travel Services
- Attend your appointment with the complete, correctly ordered document set

12. Official Source List

This guide was compiled from the following official France-Visas and Campus France Pakistan pages, plus AEG Travel Services (the official outsourced visa partner for Pakistan). Rules, fees and financial thresholds change periodically (note the financial-resources increase effective 1 August 2026) — always verify current details on these pages before applying.

Short-stay visa: <https://france-visas.gouv.fr/en/visa-de-court-sejour>

Long-stay visa: <https://france-visas.gouv.fr/en/visa-de-long-sejour>

Student: <https://france-visas.gouv.fr/en/etudiant>

Campus France Pakistan — FAQ for students:

<https://www.pakistan.campusfrance.org/frequently-asked-questions-students>

Campus France Pakistan — Apply through Études en France (Candidature campaign): <https://www.pakistan.campusfrance.org/apply-to-french-higher-education-institutions-through-etudes-en-france-candidature-campaign>

Campus France Pakistan — Apply to Student Visa (Long-Stay):

<https://www.pakistan.campusfrance.org/apply-to-student-visa-long-stay-visa-3-months>

AEG Travel Services — French Visa (appointments, fees, checklists): <https://aeg.com.pk/french-visa/>

This document is an independent informational summary for Pakistani visa applicants and is not an official publication of the French Government, France-Visas, Campus France, or AEG Travel Services.